



BULL & BEAR
RESEARCH

Fall 2025 Technology Outlook

Financial Payments

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FINTECH OVERVIEW

The Fintech Sector

The ever-growing need for quick and accessible online banking coupled with the rapid digitalization of financial services has fueled exponential growth within the financial technology, fintech, sector. The US fintech sector reached a market size of \$78.23B in 2024, with a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 19.7%. Companies within this sector seek to utilize technology to modernize traditional financial processes, looking to provide ease and efficiency to their end users. Market leaders within this segment include PayPal (PYPL), Block (XYZ), Fiserv (FIV), and SoFi (SOFI).

U.S. fintech companies are supported by a developed technological infrastructure and a bullish consumer base seeking opportunities to adopt new technology. Total funding activity (VC, PE and M&A) within fintech in the Americas reached \$69.1B in 2024, with an additional \$26.7B thus far in 2025. While investments remain substantial, recent contributions pale in comparison to the \$104.8B total invested as recent as 2022. The growing selectivity of investors can be attributed to a shift in priority towards fintech companies with real market share and profitability as the sector remains congested with speculative, hype-driven companies. Emerging technologies, specifically utilizing AI and real-time data analysis, are projected to combat the decline in investments as opportunity and segmentation within the sector grows increasingly differentiated.

Digital Assets and Currencies

With the ever-evolving nature of technology offerings, the fintech sector is continuously segmented into increasingly niche categories. Amongst these segments, digital assets and currencies differentiated itself with surging investment volumes totaling to \$8.4B in the first half of 2025 alone. With \$10.7B invested in all of 2024, the popularity surrounding digital assets is poised to grow with legislative support also backing the segment. At its current pace, the digital assets space will reach a 3-year high in global investments by the end of 2025.

Stablecoin adoption has ballooned as broader market volatility points investors towards safer assets with high liquidity. A stablecoin is a type of cryptocurrency that keeps a steady value, collateralized by reserve assets i.e. the U.S. dollar or short-term Treasuries, preventing its price from fluctuating like other cryptocurrencies. Early adopters of stablecoins argue that they transcend the current banking system allowing for speed, inclusion, and transparency within transaction services. Over the past 2 years, stablecoin transaction volume has exploded exceeding \$27T per year. With supportive legislation and improving technological infrastructure for tokenized digital assets, stablecoins are attracting investors and bolstering the size of the fintech sector entirely. This growth ultimately symbolizes the beginning of the modernization of the current payment infrastructure in use globally.

Market Capitalization of Largest U.S. Fintech Companies in 2025 (USD, Billions)

Visa	Mastercard	Intuit		Fiserv	
		162.96		134.46	
696.62	521.79	Paypal	Coinbase	Robinhood	
		78.56	64.76	52.36	

DECENTRALIZATION OF BANKING

Transition to Digital Wallets

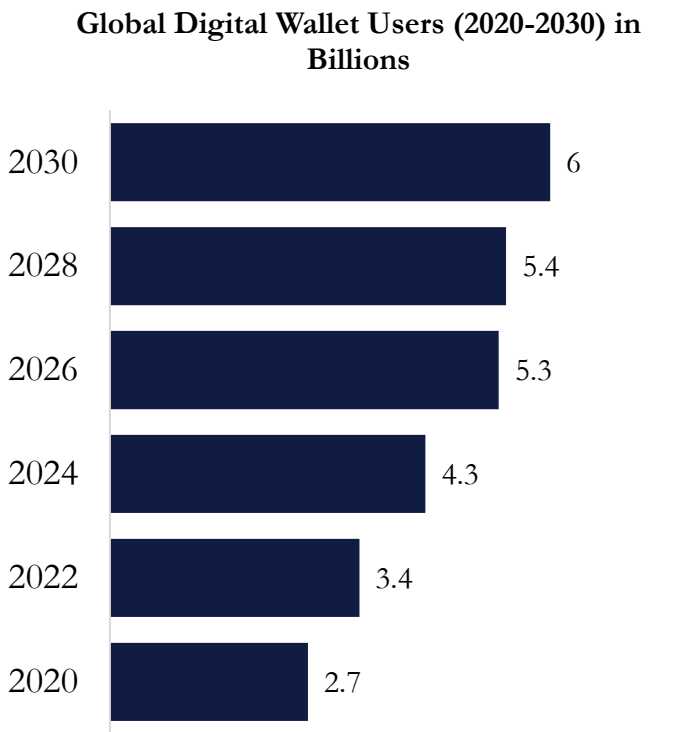
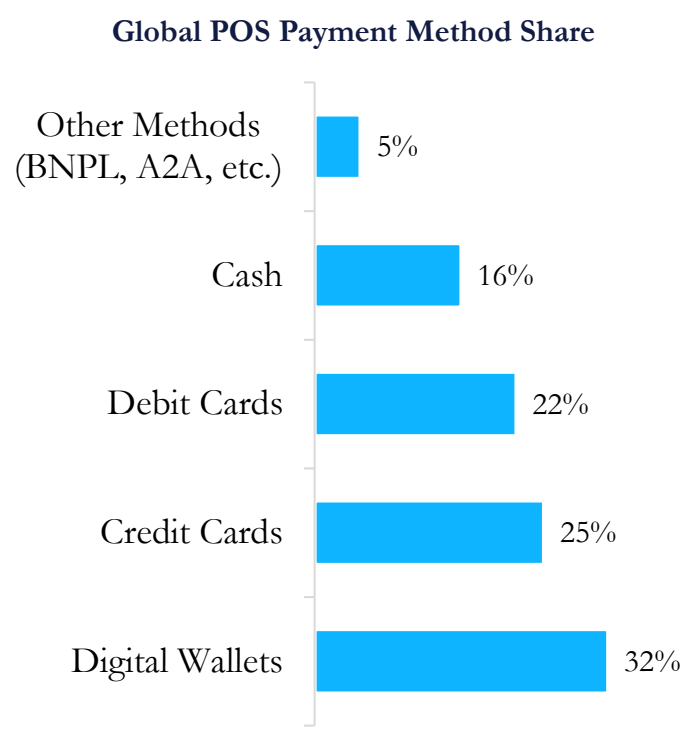
The digital banking industry is undergoing rapid decentralization as users and businesses choose to use independent digital payment systems over traditional centralized financial institutions. The adoption of mobile wallets, platform-based financial services, and cloud-based infrastructure has catalyzed this migration towards online banking. The number of digital wallet users will surpass 5.3B by 2026, which is more than half of the world’s population. The worldwide digital wallet spending market will achieve \$55.9T in 2029, with the fastest expansion happening in developing nations that use mobile banking to bypass conventional branch-based systems.

The adoption of in-store proximity payments demonstrates the shift towards digitalized payment methods. The United States saw mobile proximity payments reach \$670.5B during 2024, and experts predict they will surpass \$1T by 2027 demonstrating a transition towards bank-free tap-to-pay transactions. Payment orchestration platforms now allow merchants to direct transactions through real-time networks, wallets, alternative payment methods, and global payment service providers. This ultimately decreases both their need for traditional card networks and authorization expenses.

Shifting User Behavior

The way people use their money supports this fundamental change in financial systems. Smartwatches and fitness trackers show increasing popularity for daily transactions as 41% of consumers express interest in using these devices for payment purposes. The combination of super-app platforms in Southeast Asia, Africa, and Latin America creates unified payment, lending, and saving. In doing so, the banks' ability to serve as the main customer interface diminishes. The integration of payment functions into devices and applications makes banking operations less visible while financial infrastructure expands through fintech providers, APIs, and real-time systems.

Current market developments demonstrate that financial system transformation extends beyond consumer behavior as it involves fundamental changes to the worldwide financial infrastructure. The online payments sector stands at the forefront of industry expansion because decentralized financial systems enable e-commerce, embedded payments, and digital-first business models. The payments industry has evolved into the main competitive space for financial technological progress and business sector expansion.



SEGMENT BREAKDOWN

Mobile Wallets

Mobile payment adoption has increased rapidly in recent years and is the most common in-store digital payment type in both the United States and Europe. Also known as OEM wallets, these payment solutions are provided by smartphone manufacturers and are integrated into their operating systems, such as Apple Pay on iPhones and Google Pay on Androids. The global market for this segment was estimated at \$244bn USD in 2023 and is projected to reach \$668bn USD by 2030.

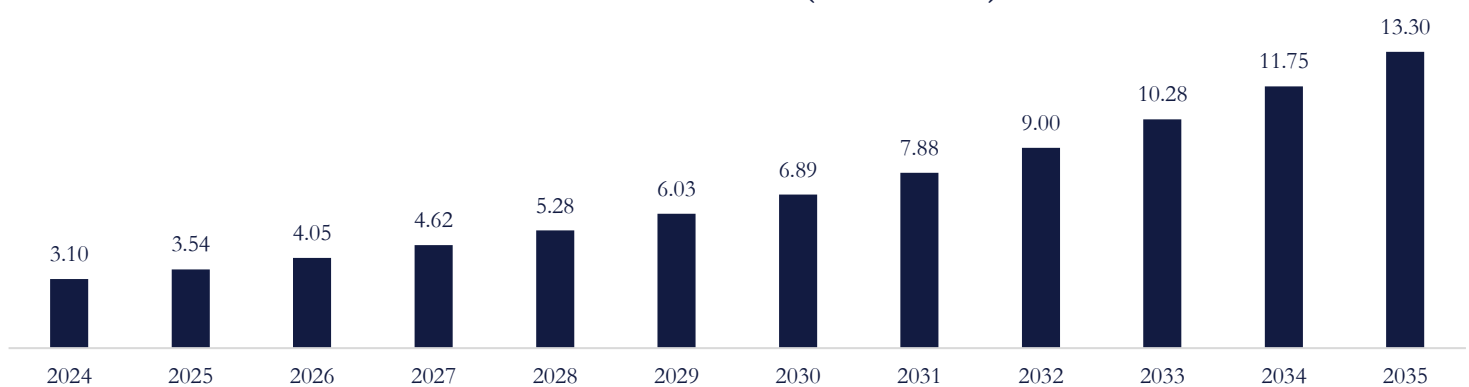
Checkout Solutions

Checkout solutions, also known as online payment platforms are global wallets provided by technology companies such as PayPal and Amazon. These wallets are the most commonly chosen option when completing in-app and online purchases in the United States and Europe. In Europe, this is likely largely driven by PayPal's market-leading position in geographically advantageous regions like the United Kingdom, Germany, and France. In contrast, in countries with local wallet solutions, such as Swish in Sweden, global checkout solutions struggle to capture the same market share as the locally based competitors. This has led to leading payment processors introducing new offerings to capture volume like Stripe partnering with TrueLayer in Europe, and VISA launching an A2A program in the United Kingdom.

Crypto & Blockchain

Cryptocurrency and Blockchain-based payment options have grown increasingly popular due to their speed, security, privacy, and seamless cross-border flexibility. Bitcoin is the most widely supported currency, with 93% of crypto-accepting businesses supporting payments with it. In the United States, Bitcoin accounted for over 40% of purchase volume in 2024, with that share expected to grow in the coming years. Adoption of crypto payments has become increasingly easy to implement with new gateway technology, which simplifies the process by converting crypto into fiat currency such as USD or EUR. This gateway market was valued between \$1.5-\$1.7 billion in 2024 and is projected to grow to over \$5 billion by 2030, with a CAGR of ~16.8%.

P2P Total Market Value (Trillion USD)



Peer-to-Peer Payment Platforms

Peer-to-peer (P2P) payments are digital transactions from one person's account to another through a third-party, without the need for a bank or other intermediaries. The most popular P2P payment options are Cash App, Zelle, Venmo, and PayPal. The shift toward peer-to-peer payments eliminates the need for physical cash or checks, offering greater convenience and efficiency in transactions. Similarly to Crypto, lower fees and broader access have resulted in cross-border transactions thriving, with a 51% growth in 2025 alone. The industry generated \$3.63B in global revenue in 2024, mainly through premium features and transaction fees. Zelle leads all competitors in total transaction volume, with over \$600B in volume in the first half of 2025, representing a 23% increase YoY. This is largely due to their integration into major banking apps such as Chase, Bank of America, and Citi.

THE PAYMENT SECTOR

Digital Wallet Technology

Digital wallet technology is an integrated payment platform that enables consumers to store their payment credentials, make contactless digital transactions, and helps manage your finances through mobile devices. By consolidating payment methods, loyalty programs, and financial services into a single interface, digital wallets help enhance transaction convenience, security, and user engagement.

Digital wallets have recently emerged as the dominating payment method globally. It currently commands 53% of e-commerce transaction volume from 2024, as shown in the bottom chart. This market share is projected to boost to 65% by 2030. Showing a major disruption within traditional payment methods. In contrast, credit cards are historically the largest leading e-commerce payment method but now have declined to just 20% market share in 2024 and are expected to fall further to 13% by 2030. Debit cards are also declining, dropping from 12% to 7%, while cash has been nearly eliminated.

Digital wallet adoption is accelerating due to key growth drivers. Smartphone adoption has now become global, providing infrastructure for mobile payments. Contactless terminals are now at over 70% of retail locations globally. Enhanced security features have now built consumer trust. The COVID-19 pandemic has now shifted the behavior toward contactless transactions. As time goes on increasingly contactless and virtual payments are occurring and becoming more popular.

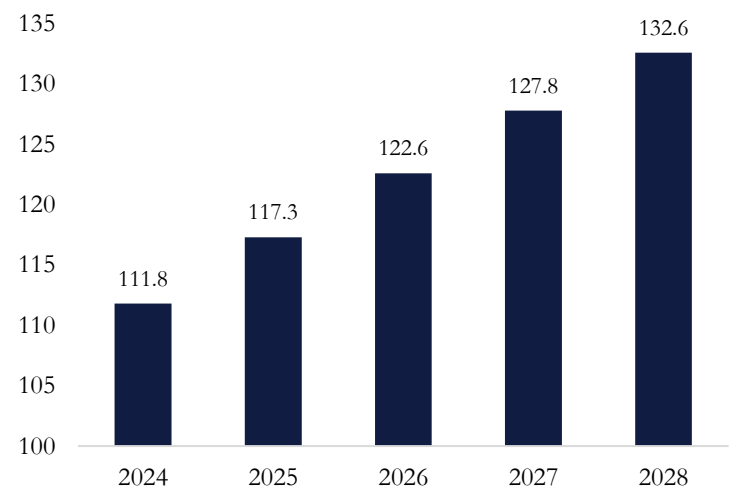
US Market Adoption Trajectory

The U.S. market reflects that proximity mobile payment users are growing from \$111.8M in 2024 to \$132.6M projected by 2028. Adding around \$20.8M users at a CAGR of 4.4%, this uptick reflects mainstream adoption.

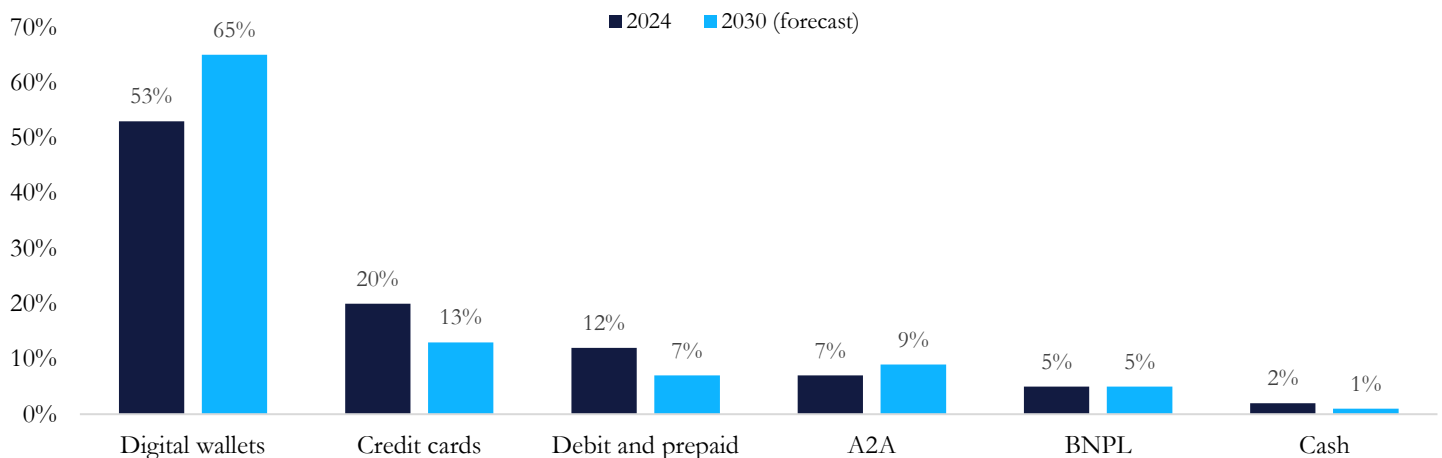
Digital wallets are projected to reach approximately 50% of smartphone users within the US by 2028. However, China has a projected adoption rate of 87.3%.

The 20.8 million net new users represent about \$260B transaction opportunity. Currently the state of the U.S. market is led by PayPal (71%), Apple Pay (38%), and Google Pay (15%). They are leading platforms achieving around 30-40% EBITDA margins at scale.

U.S. Proximity Mobile Payment User Growth (2024-2028) in Millions



Top Global E-Commerce Payment Methods



THE RISE OF AI IN FINTECH

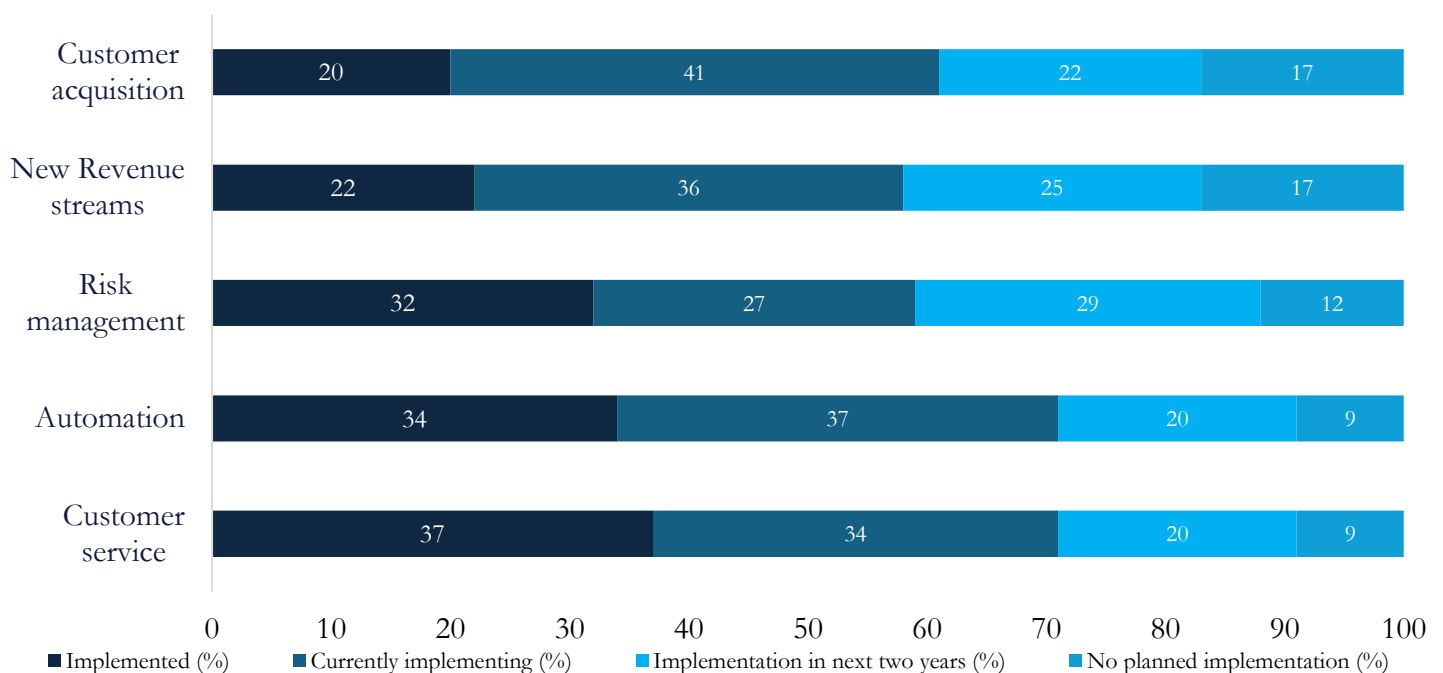
Evolution of AI in Fintech

The integration of artificial intelligence in fintech represents one of the industry's most significant transformations over the past decade. What began as experimental applications in the early 2010s has now evolved into a necessity to compete with the market. With AI seemingly entering more companies and its own growth dramatically increasing in recent years. Early AI adopters focused on narrow use cases such as chatbots and basic automation, but with the growth and technology's potential quickly expanding as machine learning algorithms prove capable of handling complex financial tasks. In today's landscape fintech companies are racing to implement AI across every aspect of their operations, driven by both competitive necessity and customer expectations for faster, more personalized services. The current landscape shows a maturity curve, established firms who invested early now leverage AI for strategic advantages in across all fields while newer entrants view AI integration as a need for market entry. This widespread adoption reflects a shift in Fintech and the Payment Sector perspective. AI is in the transition period from a futuristic concept to now an operational need, with the vast majority of fintech firms either planning or deploying AI to remain competitive in an increasingly automated financial services ecosystem.

Impact: AI Implementation Across all Business Functions

Financial technology companies are rushing to integrate artificial intelligence across their most critical business functions. With implementation rates rising it shows a strong momentum in customer and operational domains. Customer service and process reengineering lead adoption, with over 70% of fintech firms either having implemented or actively deploying AI solutions in these areas. The data reveals a strategic prioritization of AI and for immediate operational efficiency growth. Risk management shows adoption of 88% implementation or active deployment, underscoring AI's vital role in enhancing fraud detection and compliance capabilities. Meanwhile, revenue generating applications like new product development and customer acquisition. However, these are slightly behind at 58% and 61% respectively, show strong commitment with significant planned implementations over the next two years. Notably, only 10-17% of firms across all categories have no plans for AI adoption, signaling a consensus industry wide that artificial intelligence has become essential infrastructure rather than optional innovation in competitive fintech markets.

AI Adoption by Application Area



MARKET SIZE AND GROWTH

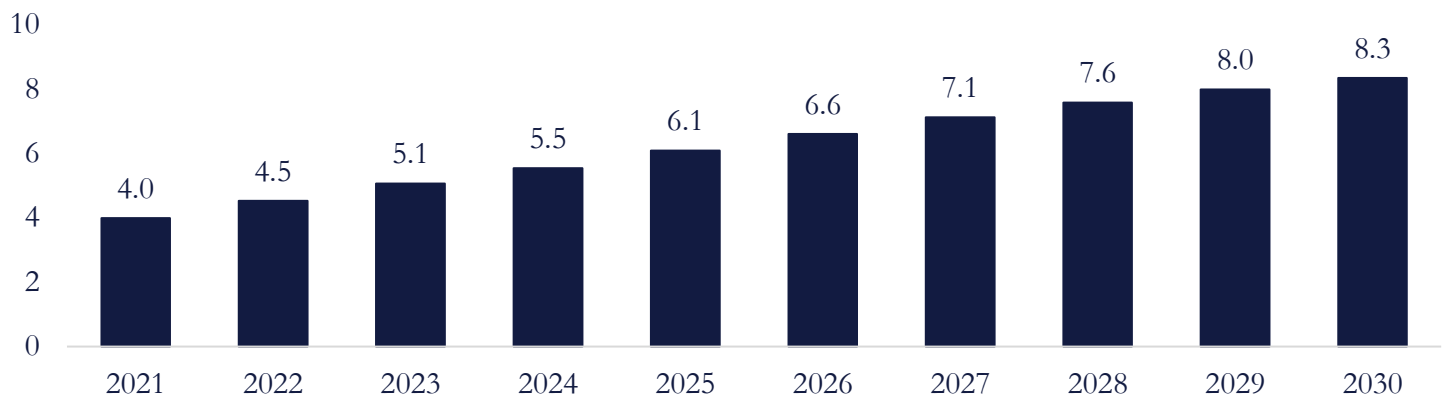
Strong Market Expansion

2024 marked a period of continued growth and change in the digital payments sector, with even greater expansion expected throughout the remainder of 2025 and beyond. The global digital payment market generated revenue of \$114.41B 2024 and is projected to reach \$361.30B by 2030, representing a CAGR of 21.40%. In 2021, 4.0B people used digital payments, accounting for over half of the global population. This number is expected to exceed 8.3B by 2030. As the user base increases rapidly, so does the transaction value of their interactions. The total transaction value across both mobile payments and digital commerce exceeded \$17.5T USD, with analysts expecting that number to reach just over \$38T USD by the end of the decade.

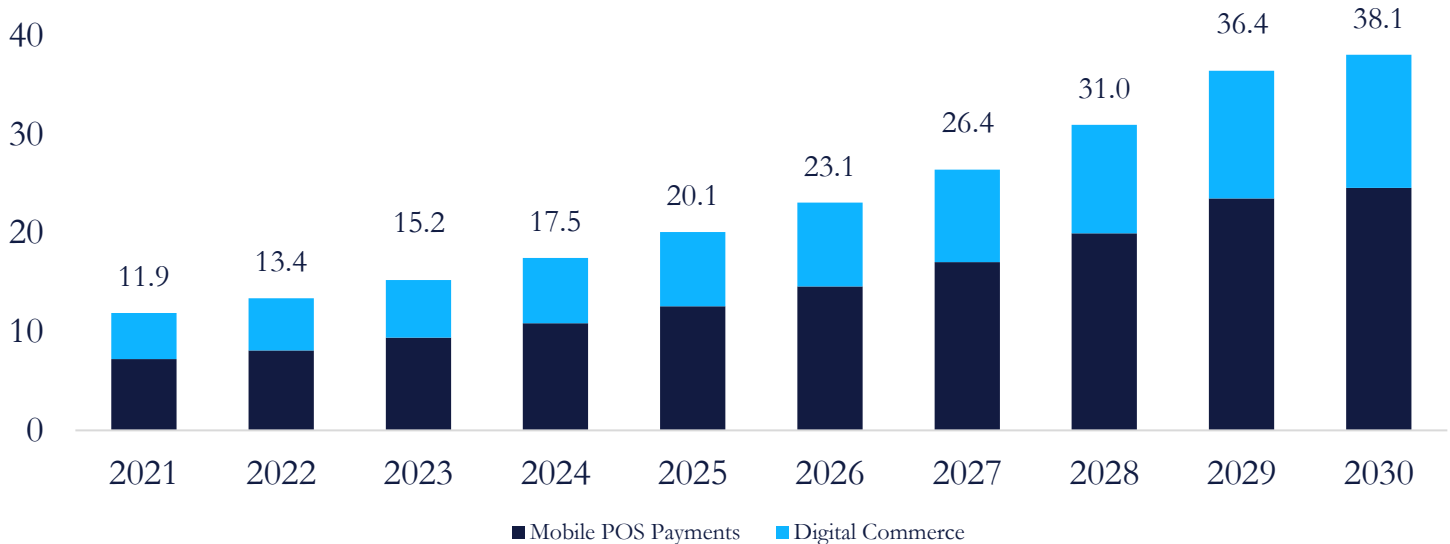
Technology as a Growth Driver

Advancement and adoption of technology is undoubtedly the main driver of growth in digital payments and wallets. As smartphone access increases globally, expected to reach 80% globally by the end of 2025, so does the shift towards a cashless, digital payment society. Annual digital payments per capita grew 29% in 2023 among emerging markets and developing economies, driven by a 48% growth in e-money and digital wallet payments. Also, the creation of real-time payment infrastructure by central banks such as FedNow by the Federal Reserve and UPI by the Royal Bank of India has further improved transaction efficiency, allowing instant fund transfers between financial institutions and prompting broader adoption among businesses and consumers alike.

Digital Payment Users (in Billions)



Digital Payments Transaction Value (Trillion USD)



FINTECH TRENDS

Digital Wallets and Payment Trends

The digital payments ecosystem has shifted from rapid growth to efficiency-driven maturity, with interoperability fueling its evolution. India’s Unified Payments Interface (UPI) connects over 600 banks and 200 apps, enabling seamless cross-provider transactions. This open framework lowers barriers, drives third-party innovation, and supports small merchants with tools like sandbox confirmations and QR payments. Similar models are emerging across Latin America and Southeast Asia as governments embrace

Digital wallet providers are evolving into full-stack financial platforms. Curve’s CEO describes this shift as moving from “transaction facilitators to financial management platforms,” enabled by open NFC access and AI personalization. Regulatory moves, such as Apple opening its NFC layer, are allowing new entrants to challenge Big Tech. PitchBook (Q2 2025) reports high-growth payments firms gained a median +19.9% return, reflecting optimism in finance and neobank-linked solutions

The World Economic Forum notes digital payments make up 34% of all fintech firms, with 37% customer and 40% revenue growth from 2022–2023. Financial inclusion data reveals that 47% of users are low-income and 41% are women, showing wallets’ role in expanding access. As competition widens, fraud management, tokenization, and AI authentication remain vital to maintaining trust and efficiency.

Sector Trends

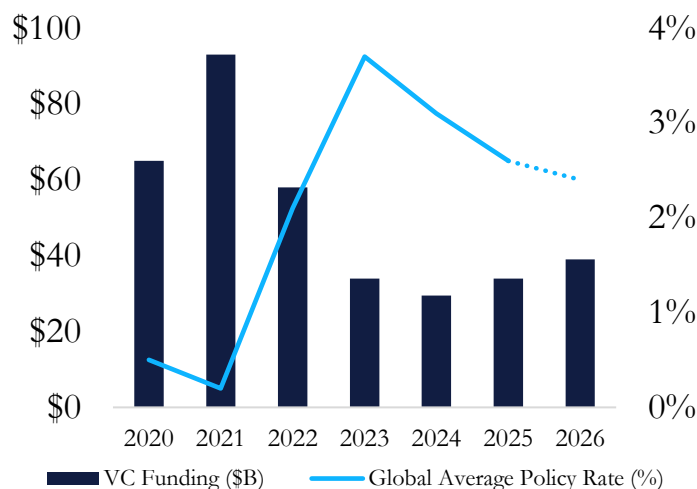
At the intersection of technical innovation and economic normality is the fintech and payments industry. The World Economic Forum reveals that 84% of fintech's collaborate with incumbents, indicating a shift away from hypergrowth, which has led to less disruption.

In 2025, the market is cautiously optimistic. Rising fintech VC exits and IPOs like ServiceTitan and MobiKwik have regained investor trust and increased payments firms' returns (+17–20% YTD). Although the industry is still susceptible to interest-rate fluctuations that impact funding and transaction volumes, the IPO recovery signifies valuation stabilization and fresh capital flow.

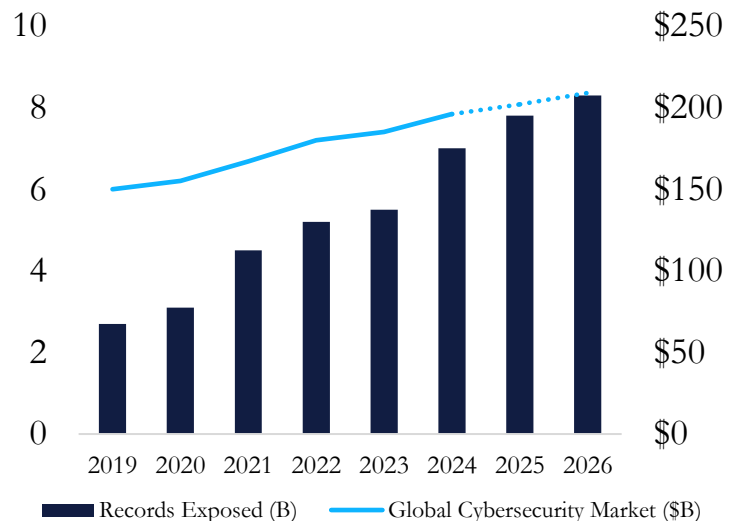
80% of fintech's now utilize AI for fraud detection and customer service, which improves CX by 83% and reduces costs by 75%. The \$350B market for embedded finance is growing beyond payments to include credit, insurance, and payroll, particularly for SMEs. This connects lending, savings, and payments.

According to the IMF, macro instability (18%) and regulatory fragmentation (14%) are the two main growth barriers. However, attitude has improved as open-banking alignment advances and funding stabilizes. The sector is poised to enter a phase of strategic consolidation because of the growth driven by the implementation of AI, rate normalization, and cross-border interoperability.

Global Interest Rates vs Fintech Funding (2020–2026)



Security Pressure on Payments



REGULATIONS AND POLICY

The GENIUS Act and Stablecoin Regulation

The GENIUS Act (Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for U.S. Stablecoins Act) was signed into law on July 18, 2025, and established the first comprehensive federal system for oversight of payment stablecoins. The Act specified that payment stablecoin issuers must be federally chartered or certified and approved by the OCC (Office of the Controller of Currency) to operate in the United States. This new law prohibits all non-qualified entities from creating stablecoins or enabling stablecoin transactions unless they obtain approval from an authorized issuer.

The Paxos Trust Company works together with PayPal for issuing PayPal's Stablecoin: (PYUSD). At the time, the company launched the stablecoin to drive development in Web3 payments, as well as to bridge the divide between traditional and digital finance. It serves as an introduction to cryptocurrency as well, for users who are unfamiliar and do not want to enter the volatile market, but instead a stable, US dollar-backed currency. The new law accepts PYUSD as a compliant stablecoin because it operates with a 1:1 peg and uses fully reserved assets for backing. The new regulations require smaller fintech companies and crypto-native platforms to establish OCC-compliant governance systems, risk management protocols, and compliance frameworks to continue their operations.

The market has started to demonstrate its response to the new regulations. The cost of compliance for stablecoin issuers will reach between \$2M and \$5M per year, based on moderate program requirements, which include audit services, Anti-Money Laundering (AML) systems, Know Your Customer (KYC) verification, and legal and regulatory personnel. The AML and KYC systems must be up to par with the standards in the banking sector, with suspicious activity reporting, increased due diligence on high-risk accounts, and transaction monitoring software.

“The Big Beautiful Bill”

On July 4th, 2025, the Overseas Bank and Borderless Business Act (OBBA), known as the Big Beautiful Bill, was passed to establish new regulatory requirements for payment technology businesses. The new Section 70604 of the law requires payment technology companies to pay a 1% federal excise tax on all cross-border remittance transactions. The tax applies to all transfer initiations made through physical instruments such as cash and money orders, cashier's checks, and other physical payment methods. The law establishes two separate compliance areas for payment rails because it excludes account-based transfers and transactions funded by U.S.-issued debit or credit cards.

The new tax requirements caused traditional remittance routes between Mexico and India to experience immediate changes in their transaction volumes because providers modified their pricing systems to handle the additional costs. The companies that operate through cash-to-digital remittances, such as Western Union and MoneyGram, experienced increased compliance expenses and reduced profit margins. Still, companies like Wise and Remitly maintained their cost benefits from card and account-based transfers.

The bill restored the pre-2021 IRS 1099-K reporting threshold, which now requires businesses to report payments exceeding \$20,000 or involving more than 200 transactions. The change in reporting requirements brought substantial relief to small merchants, payment facilitators, and gig economy workers who now face less administrative work. The increased 1099-K form reporting threshold at Payment Service Providers (PSPs) resulted in reduced back-office complexity, which made it easier to onboard users and maintain their accounts. The new 200-transaction threshold will trigger a very certain number of people, like full-time delivery drivers, due to high-volume transactions. On the other hand, small businesses are positively impacted as compliance or tax forms won't be an issue till the threshold, making the process significantly more efficient for users and the companies.

DIGITAL LIQUIDITY INFRASTRUCTURE

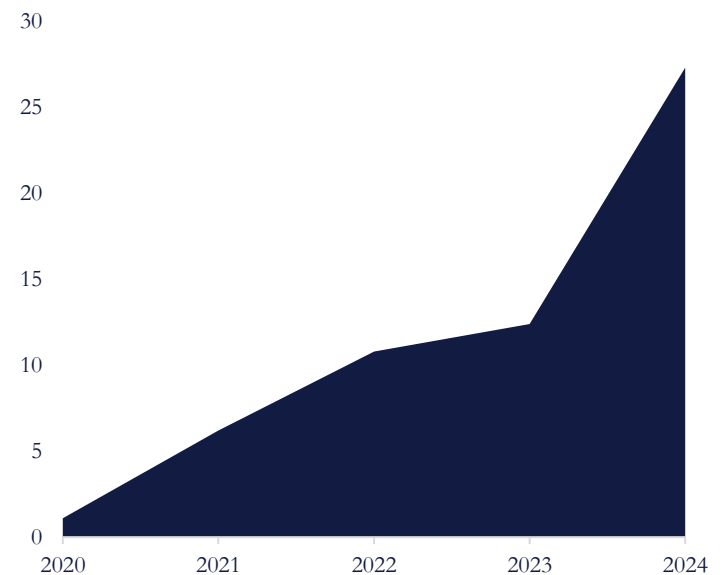
Stable Coins

Stable coins have become essential to global digital payments, processing over \$27T in on-chain transactions in 2024. These digital assets representing dollars enable instant, low-cost cross border payments that bypass traditional correspondent banking networks. Transaction fees stay under \$1, compared to \$25–\$50 for international wire transfers. Because of this efficiency, major payment companies including Visa, Mastercard, and PayPal have integrated stable coin rails.

Stable coins are especially valuable in the remittance market, reducing costs from 7% to 10% to under 1 percent and settling transfers in minutes instead of days. Stripe’s \$1.1B acquisition of Bridge in 2024 showed strong institutional confidence in stable coins as core payment infrastructure.

Adoption is growing fastest in emerging markets, where people use stable coins for everyday purchases and to protect savings during currency instability. Their programmability also enables automated treasury operations, real-time settlement for e-commerce, and embedded finance use cases that traditional payment systems cannot efficiently support

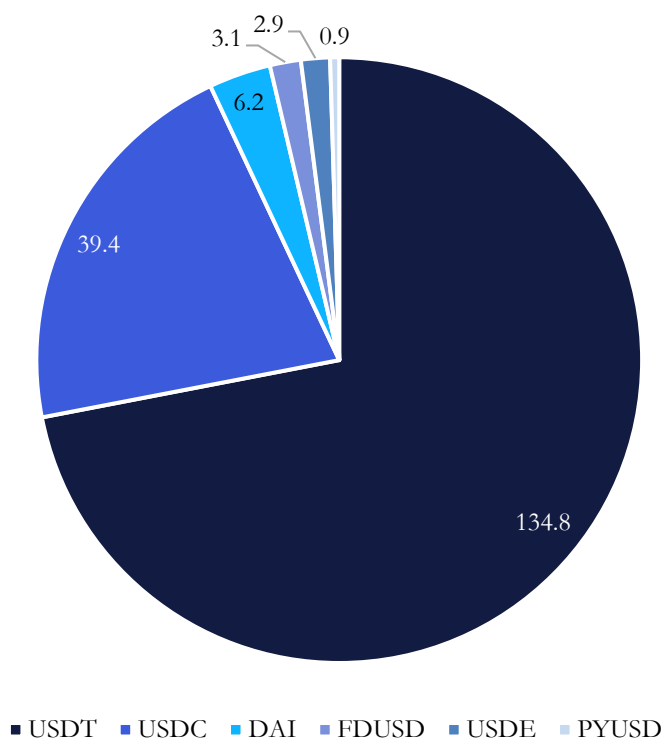
Transaction Volume of Stable Coins (\$T)



Transaction Volume of Stable Coins

Traditional financial institutions are rapidly integrating stable coins into their operations, marking a fundamental shift from crypto-native to mainstream adoption. Major banks including JPMorgan, Citi, and HSBC have launched or piloted tokenized deposit products, while asset managers like BlackRock and Franklin Templeton have entered the stable coin market. PayPal's PYUSD and Stripe's expanded stable coin support signal that payment giants view these assets as core infrastructure rather than experimental technology. Regulatory clarity is advancing significantly, with the EU's MiCA framework establishing comprehensive stable coin rules and US legislation gaining bipartisan momentum. However, regulatory fragmentation across jurisdictions creates compliance complexity, and the collapse of algorithmic stable coins in 2022 elevated scrutiny on reserve backing and transparency, pushing the industry toward fiat-backed models with regular attestations. Central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) represent both validation of the technology and potential competition, though private stable coins maintain advantages in innovation speed and global interoperability. The regulatory endgame will likely distinguish between stable coin types, with payment-focused stable coins facing bank-like regulation while maintaining the operational flexibility that drives their adoption advantage.

Market Cap (\$B)



INDUSTRY HEADWINDS

Margin & Fee Pressure

The digital payments ecosystem is experiencing rising transaction costs and increasing competition, compressing profit margins at an alarming rate. For small and medium-sized enterprises, the costs of processing digital payments are often prohibitive, forcing many to stick with traditional payment methods to avoid expenses and fees. Meanwhile, payment providers are under pressure as consumers migrate to lower-fee options, forcing firms to either accept market share loss or offer more attractive offerings at the cost of decreased margins. This is evident as digital payment transaction volumes consistently outpaced revenue growth (17% vs 6%) from 2018-2023. These gradually declining margins represent both competition and scale.

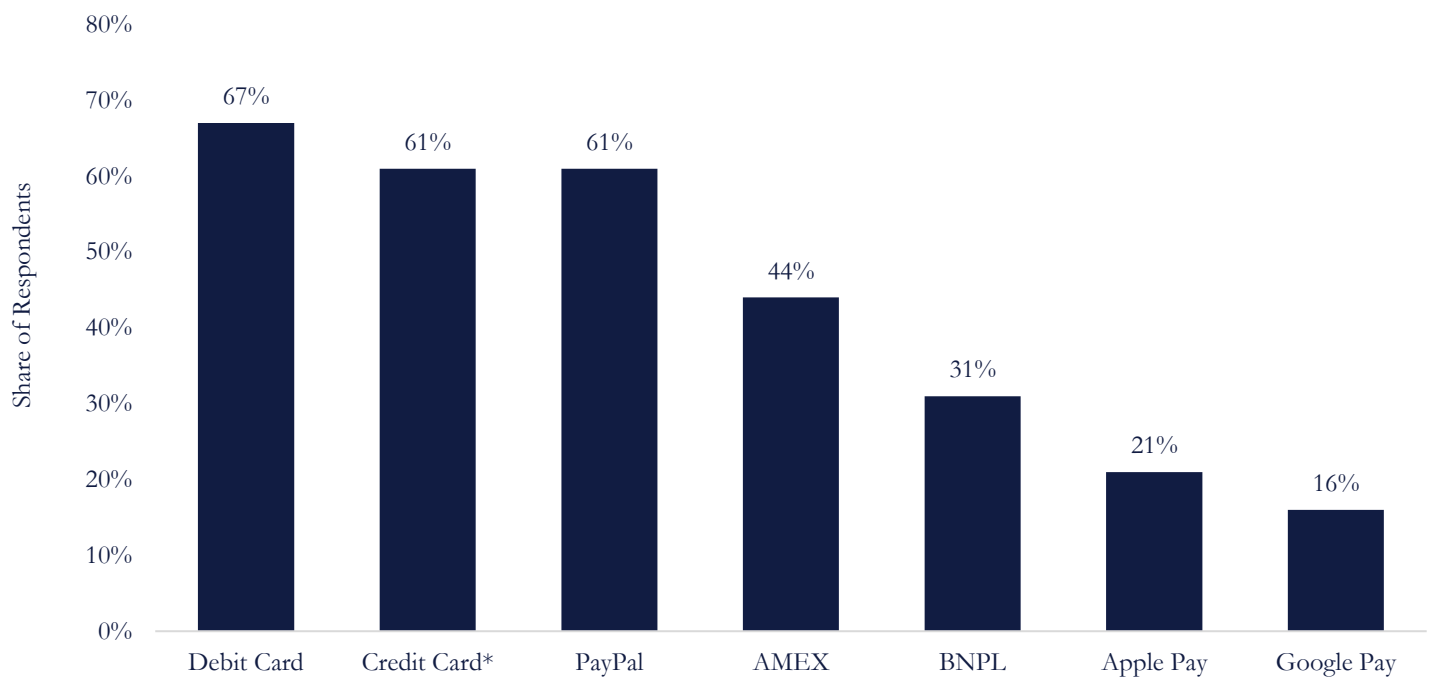
Fraud & Security Risks

The inevitable consequence of an industry entangled and sustained by technology is heightened exposure to fraud, cyberattacks, and other tech-enabled risks. The global cost of digital payment fraud is projected to exceed \$50B in 2025 alone, with attack rates remaining high at 3.3% of all transactions. This threat is widespread, as over 80% organizations worldwide reported being targeted by payment fraud, and mobile-based attacks now account for $\frac{3}{4}$ of all incidents. Digital wallets are also a concern, as 20% of accounts were compromised in 2024, with rates expected to increase. As digital payment and wallet technologies expand, it will be vital for security to improve as well to ensure business and customer trust remains.

Regulatory and Cross-Border Complexities

The rapid expansion of digital payments has brought growing regulatory and compliance pressures. Regulators are requiring faster, more efficient payment processes that also feature 24/7 support and fraud protection, all while maintaining low costs for businesses and consumers. These extensive demands have strained payment providers, as many are struggling to respond quickly, especially those with outdated systems not prepared to support such changes. These complexities only increase when dealing with cross-border transactions. Cross-border digital transactions face high fees, regulatory restrictions, and inconsistent infrastructure. Global retail payment fees average over 6%, and fund settlement can span days when transactions pass through intermediaries. Payment providers often absorb most of the fees, as high competition once again forces them to offer competitive rates to consumers.

Leading Methods of Payment Fraud According to E-Merchants Worldwide



*Excluding American Express

INDUSTRY TAILWINDS

Shift Toward Digital Banking

There is an accelerating shift toward digital and mobile financial services, and it is proving to be a major tailwind for the FinTech industry. In 2024 it was reported that 70% of Millennials and Gen Z typically use at least one FinTech app as their primary financial tool. Mobile digital banking logins are more common than branch visits by 15x. The global digital payments market have surpassed \$9T in 2023 and is now projected to grow at a CAGR of 14–16% through 2028. With an increase in smartphone adoption, improved digital infrastructure, contactless payments are at a great increase. FinTech companies that are built natively on mobile and cloud platforms, are better competitively positioned within the market compared to traditional banks, as they deliver fast, personalized, and seamless user experiences, enabling them to capture growing market share across payments, lending, and wealth management.

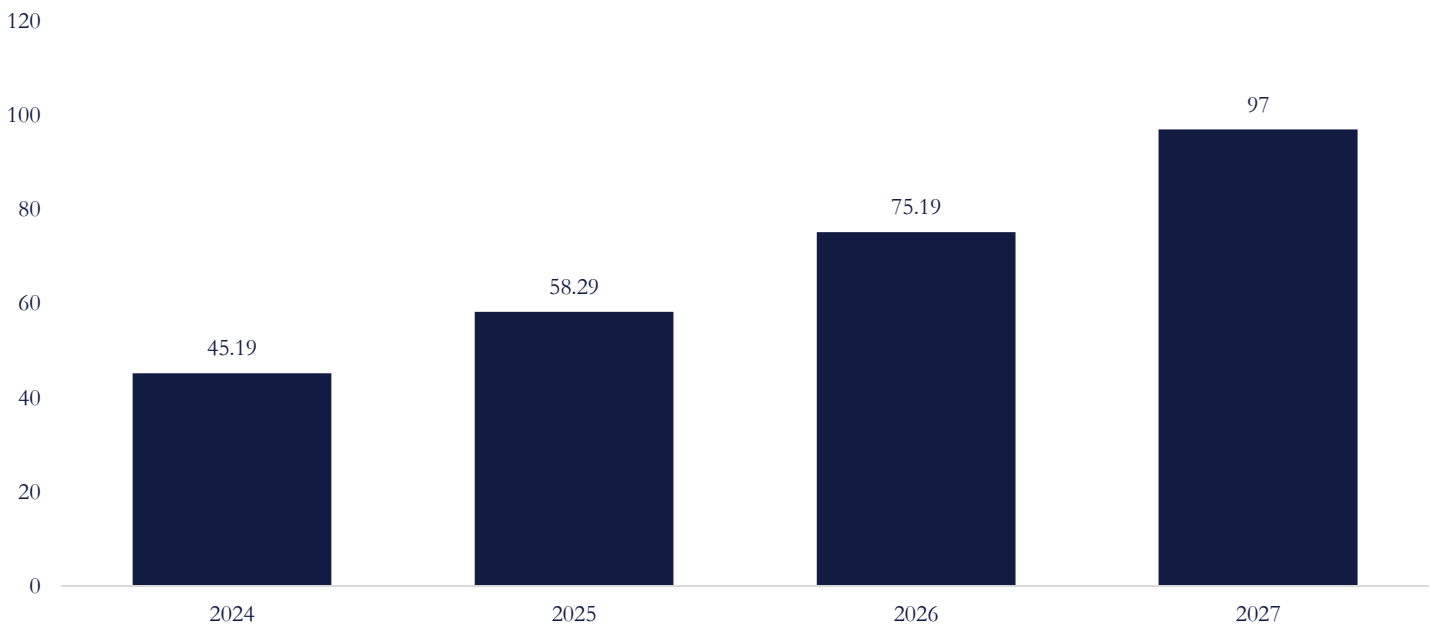
Open Banking Initiatives

Embedded payments have been a major growth driver within the FinTech sector. As financial services have begun integrated directly into non-financial platforms such as e-commerce, ridesharing, and subscription applications. Instead of redirecting users to external checkout pages or banks, embedded payments allow transactions to occur natively within apps, creating a faster and more seamless user experience. Companies like Uber, Amazon, Shopify, and DoorDash have already transformed customer expectations by making payments “invisible.” As a result, the embedded finance market is projected to surpass \$7T in transaction value by 2030, with payments as the largest and fastest-growing segment. By enabling frictionless digital payments at scale, embedded payments are reshaping the future of commerce and accelerating FinTech adoption across industries.

Regulatory to Global Fintech Expansion

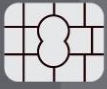
Rapid growth in AI and data analytics is a major tailwind for the FinTech industry, enabling personalized financial services, real time fraud detection, automated underwriting, and now robot advisors. Global spending on AI in banking is expected to pass \$100B by 2030, growing at a over a 30% CAGR. Cloud computing and public open APIs are allowing FinTech companies to involve AI at a scale, helping to reduce operating costs, and enhance customer experience. As these technologies continue to innovate and improve upon itself, they will continue to improve efficiency, business models, and will accelerate FinTech adoption worldwide.

Financial Sector AI Spending (Billion USD)



LEE M CARDHOLDER

citi



4100 4354 32453 3452

VALUED CUSTOMER

VISA
Signature

RedCard

Credit

123 435

VALUED CUS

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VALUED CUSTOMER

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RESEARCH

CapitalOne

Comparable Company Analysis



1234 56

LOWE'S

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VALUED CUSTOMER

VISA
Signature

BEST
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LEE M CARDHOLDER



Cap

PEER UNIVERSE

Logo	Company	Ticker	Description	LTM Revenue (millions USD)
	PayPal	PYPL	Allows users to make online and person-to-person transactions while transferring funds between consumers and merchants.	32,292
	SoFi	SOFI	Provides student loan refinancing and personal loans and credit cards and digital banking solutions.	3,057.9
	American Express	AXP	Multinational financial services organization which specializes in charge and credit card products.	70,428
	Visa	V	Manages one of the biggest card networks to protect both consumer and merchant financial transactions.	38,893
	Mastercard	MA	A payment network that connects consumers, merchants, and financial institutions using global transaction processing.	30,241
	Capital One	COF	Diversified financial institution that offers credit cards, auto loans, and consumer banking services through digital platforms.	48,041
	Upstart	UPST	Company leverages AI to evaluate credit risk through machine learning algorithms which then matches borrowers with partner banks.	851.8
	Block	XYZ	Payment processing and POS systems and consumer financial services through its Cash App and Square platforms.	23,834.6
	Fiserv	FI	Financial technology solutions provider that delivers payment processing and digital banking, and core account services to financial institutions.	21,112

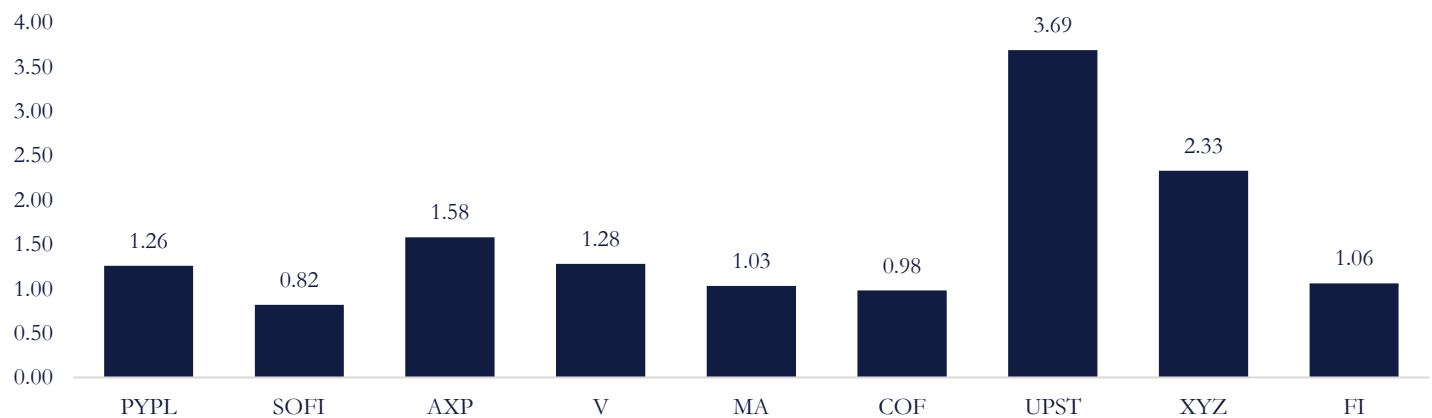
Public payment-technology providers are continuing to grow as the global economy rapidly shifts over towards digital and card-based transactions. Visa, for the fiscal year 2025, reported a net revenue of \$40B which is an 11.33% increase year-over-year, during the third quarter of 2025 the company processed \$65.4B transactions which totaled out to \$3.341T in payment volume. Consumers and Businesses have been making frequent usage of mobile wallets and e-commerce, providers of these networks like Visa and Mastercard have become an essential backbone for trade around the world. As widespread adoption increases, these companies are seen by investors as growth platforms with scaling potential that will maintain high recurring revenues. However, top payment-technology companies still maintain premium valuation multiples which clearly represents their critical role in the FinTech space.

COMPARABLE: LIQUIDITY

Company	Operating Cash Flow	Current Assets	Current Liabilities	Total Liabilities	Liquidity			Leverage	
					Current Ratio	Quick Ratio	Cash Ratio	Debt / Equity	Debt / Inv. Capital
PYPL	7,450.00	61,092.00	48,376.00	61,194.00	1.26	0.22	0.24	52.13	34.27
SOFI	(1,119.80)	21,641.00	26,535.70	29,725.80	0.82	0.36	0.50	48.89	32.84
AXP	14,050.00	243,670.00	154,671.00	241,197.00	1.58	0.17	1.58	168.81	61.11
V	19,950.00	34,033.00	26,517.00	55,374.00	1.28	0.57	0.67	55.37	31.07
MA	14,780.00	19,724.00	19,220.00	41,566.00	1.03	0.46	0.64	291.42	74.45
COF	18,159.00	357,922.00	363,935.00	429,360.00	0.98	0.11	0.12	75.33	42.22
UPST	186.30	1224.50	331.57	1,381.80	3.69	3.06	2.94	229.38	69.64
XYZ	1,707.40	19,880.20	8,546.80	15,542.60	2.33	0.99	1.01	30.94	19.37
FI	6,631.00	23,477.00	22,157.00	49,490.00	1.06	0.06	0.22	92.5	48.05
Lower	(1,119.80)	1,224.46	331.57	1,381.89	0.82	0.06	0.12	30.94	19.37
Median	7,450.00	23,477.00	26,517.00	49,490.00	1.26	0.36	0.64	75.33	42.22
Mean	9,088.21	86,962.63	74,476.67	102,759.02	1.56	0.67	0.88	116.09	45.89
Upper	19,950.00	357,922.00	363,935.00	429,360.00	3.69	3.06	2.94	291.42	74.45

In reviewing the liquidity ratios and financial metrics for the companies listed, Upstart Holdings stands out with exceptionally high liquidity as evidenced by its current ratio (3.69), quick ratio (3.06), and cash ratio (2.94), all of which exceed those of the other comparable companies. Visa, Mastercard, and American Express also demonstrate financial strength, with free cash flows of \$19.95B, \$18.16B, and \$14.78B, respectively. Fiserv Inc. exhibits the weakest liquidity, with the lowest quick ratio (0.11) and a very low cash ratio (0.22), which could reflect a tighter liquidity position that could affect its ability to meet immediate financial obligations. On the leverage side, Mastercard, American Express, and Upstart Holdings have extremely high Debt-to-Equity ratios with 291.42, 168.81, and 229.38, respectively. In most other industries, these numbers would be cause for concern but companies in the payments sector use debt to fund rapid expansion because of their structure. These ratios also reflect their ability to leverage debt to finance growth, while maintaining high credit ratings and access to cheap debt financing.

Current Ratios

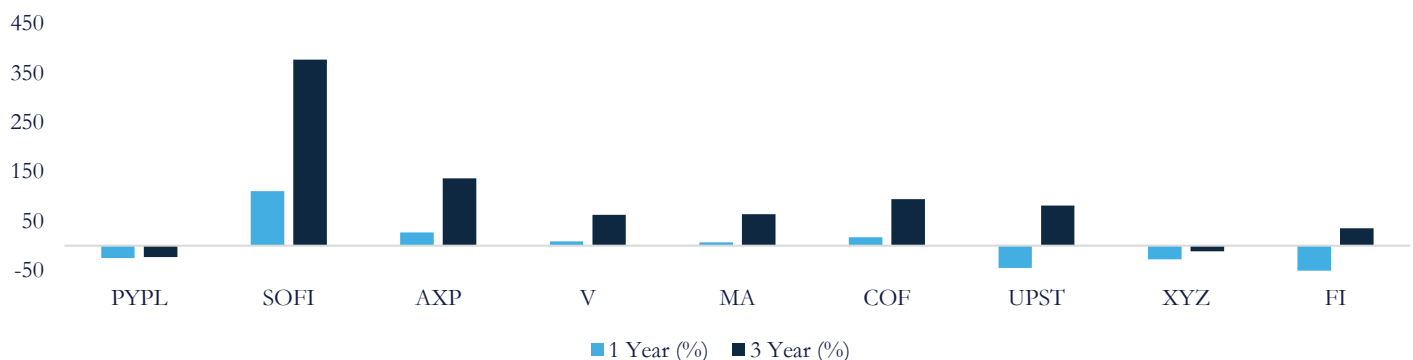


COMPARABLE: PROFITABILITY

Ticker	Revenue (\$B)	EBITDA (\$B)	Net Income (\$B)	Total Assets (\$B)	Total Equity (\$B)	EBITDA / Revenue (%)	ROA (%)	ROE (%)	1 Year (%)	3 Year (%)
PYPL	32.86	7.48	4.92	81.61	20.42	23.0	6.18	23.6	-25.17	-23.07
SOFI	3.32	0.79	0.64	36.25	6.53	23.80	1.77	9.81	110.30	376.71
AXP	70.43	23.08	10.41	271.46	30.26	32.77	3.83	34.4	26.80	136.64
V	40.00	26.00	20.06	99.63	37.09	65.0	20.1	54.1	8.60	62.48
MA	31.47	19.42	14.25	48.08	6.52	61.7	29.7	218.7	6.46	63.70
COF	48.23	-	1.14	490.14	60.78	-	0.23	1.87	16.85	94.34
UPST	0.96	0.042	0.03	2.37	0.63	4.34	1.36	5.09	-45.00	81.37
XYZ	23.97	2.67	3.14	36.78	21.23	11.1	8.52	14.8	-27.41	-11.34
FI	21.16	9.08	3.61	77.18	27.69	42.9	4.68	13.0	-50.65	35.47
Lower	0.96	0.042	0.03	2.37	0.63	0.23	0.23	1.87	-50.65	-23.07
Median	31.47	8.28	3.61	77.18	21.23	28.29	4.68	14.80	8.60	63.70
Mean	30.27	11.07	6.47	127.06	23.46	30.23	8.49	41.71	25.89	90.70
Upper	70.43	26.00	20.06	490.14	60.78	65.00	29.70	218.7	110.30	376.71

The return profiles between SoFi, Upstart, Visa, and American Express demonstrate how fintech companies separate into two distinct groups between disruptive new businesses and established market leaders. SoFi achieved outstanding returns of 110% during the previous year and 376.71% during the three-year period because investors backed its fast user acquisition and complete financial service expansion. The stock performance of Upstart shows a volatile path due to its 45% decline during the previous year while maintaining 81% three-year growth which depends on investor sentiment about AI lending and credit market stability. The financial performance of these companies shows no signs of fluctuation because they maintain stable operations. The financial performance of Visa and American Express produced positive results through their stable operations and established brand value and steady customer base. The market values SoFi and Upstart based on their future growth potential, yet Visa and Amex maintain their value through their reliable earnings and worldwide operations. The sector operates with a dual-speed system which rewards established cash-generating businesses and innovative growth ventures but responds negatively to unstable performance and weak results.

1Y vs 3Y Returns (%)

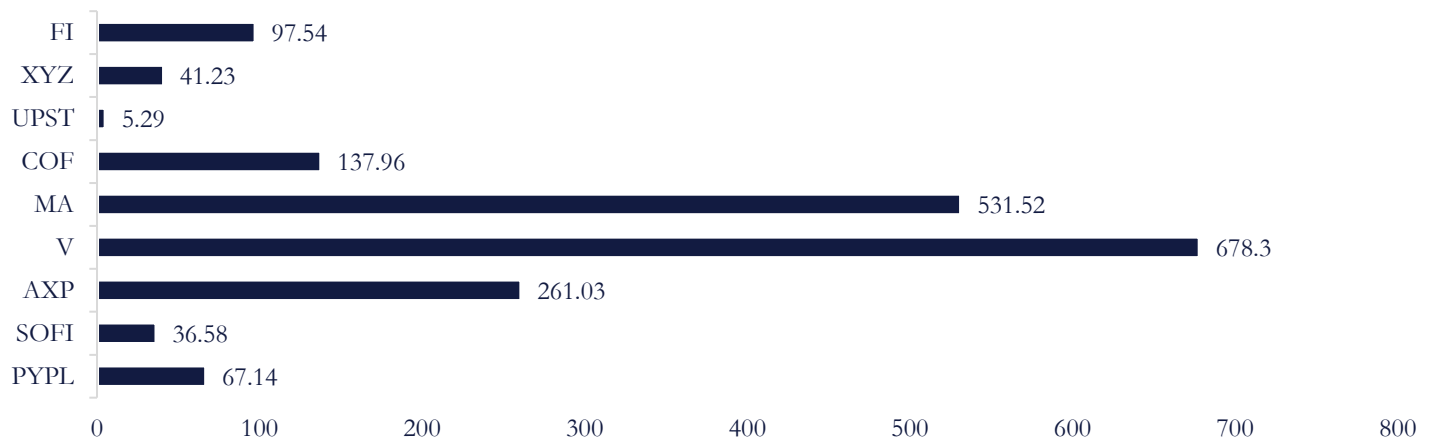


COMPARABLE: VALUATION

Ticker	Market Cap (\$B)	EV (\$B)	Diluted EPS (TTM)	EV / Revenue	EV / EBITDA	Trailing P/E	Forward P/E	PX/Sales (TTM)
PYPL	65.85	67.14	4.98	2.08	9.25	14.76	11.89	2.14
SOFI	31.1	36.58	0.56	11.5	33.12	51.94	47.17	9.97
AXP	229.98	261.03	14.89	4.22	15.81	23.21	18.83	3.39
V	671.47	678.3	19.85	17.44	26.01	33.78	26.95	16.93
MA	521.91	531.52	15.62	17.58	29.22	38.93	30.67	17.49
COF	136.72	137.96	2.92	4.41	19.32	593.83	10.86	2.07
UPST	5.09	5.29	0.26	7.77	72.37	151.14	125.00	6.09
XYZ	46.82	41.23	4.97	1.73	17.08	16.41	20.66	2.04
FI	68.36	97.54	6.47	4.62	10.50	21.03	10.60	3.37
Lower	38.96	41.23	2.92	4.22	15.81	21.03	11.89	2.14
Median	68.36	97.54	4.98	4.62	19.32	33.78	20.66	3.39
Mean	197.48	206.29	7.84	7.93	25.85	105.00	33.63	7.05
Upper	375.95	261.03	14.89	11.5	29.22	51.94	30.67	9.97

The fintech sector's growth potential is reflected in valuation metrics such as price-to-earnings (P/E) ratios, price-to-sales ratios, and enterprise value-to-EBITDA multiples. Firms like Upstart (UPST) and SoFi (SOFI) exhibit exceptionally high trailing P/E ratios of 151.14 and 51.94, respectively, showing investors' willingness to pay a premium for their strong growth prospects. Additionally, the forward P/E ratios for these firms are lower than their trailing P/E ratios, indicating expectations of improved future earnings and potential undervaluation based on growth outlook. High enterprise value-to-EBITDA multiples for companies such as Mastercard (MA), Visa (V), and SoFi (SOFI)—at 29.22, 26.01, and 33.12, respectively—reflect strong investor confidence in profitability expansion and sustained demand across the fintech industry. This trend underscores the sector's transformation toward digital payments and lending solutions, positioning fintech firms as key drivers of financial innovation.

Enterprise Value (USD, Billions)





M&A and IPO Activity



M&A Activity

Deal Flow Commentary

Broader deal market activity within the Fintech landscape continues to heat up as larger Fintech firms such as MasterCard, SoFi, Visa, Paypal, and American Express look to expand within their industry. Although Fintech M&A crashed in 2023, deal activity is now up 5% year over year compared to 2024. It is believed that Fintech M&A is expected to return to the 2021 level with more realistic valuations compared to grow it all costs mentality in 2021.

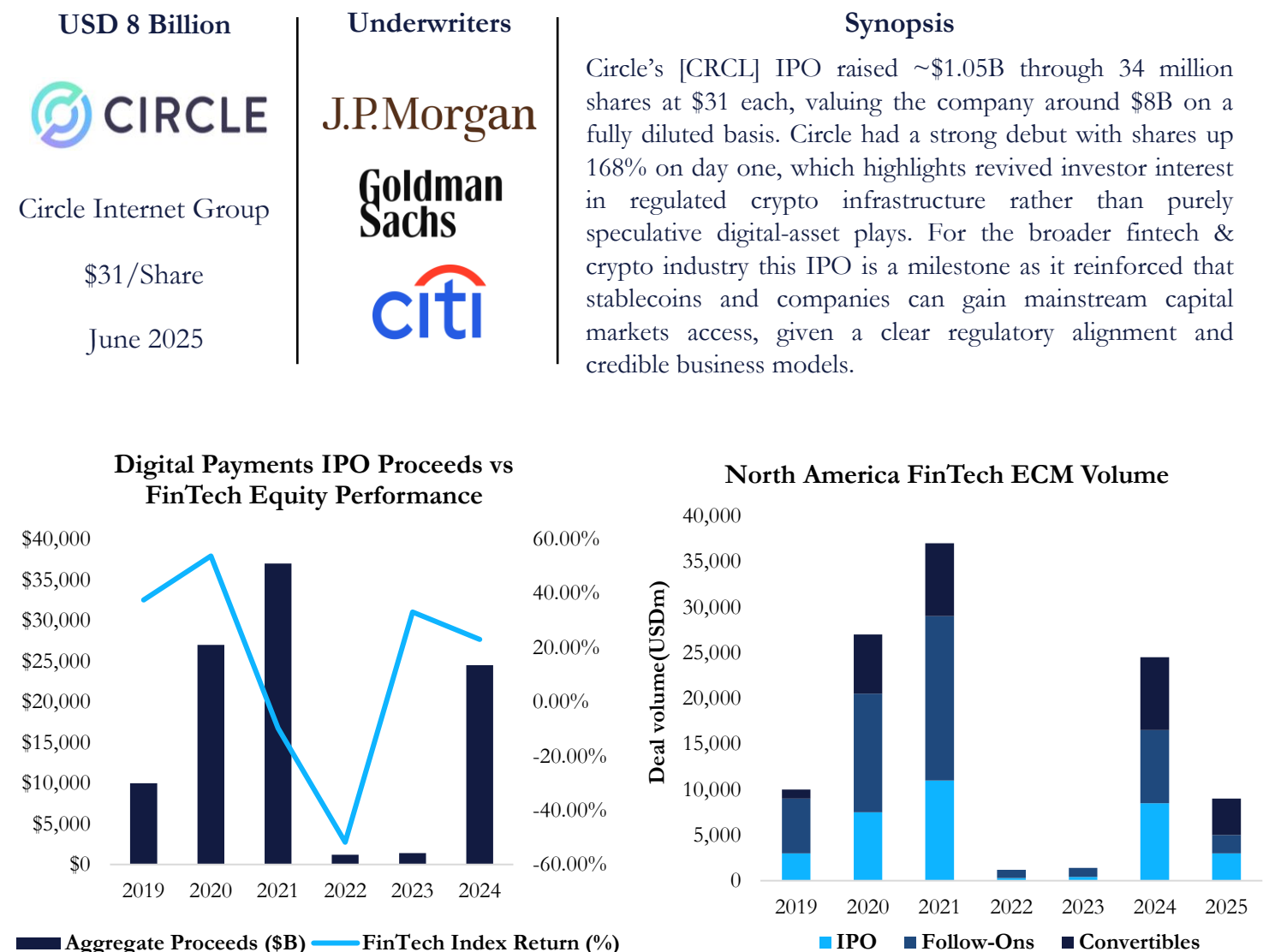
Price 2.65B  Acquisition of  December 2024	Advisors 	Synopsis Mastercard acquired Recorded Future, an AI-driven threat-intelligence platform, in a \$2.65B deal to strengthen its cybersecurity and fraud-prevention capabilities. Recorded Future analyzes open-source, dark-web, and technical data to provide real-time insight into emerging threats. The acquisition enhances Mastercard's ability to protect its network, improve risk detection, and support customers facing growing cyber and fraud challenges.
Deal Price  Acquisition of FEATURE SPACE December 2024	Advisors 	Synopsis Visa acquired Feature space, an AI-driven payments protection and fraud-detection platform, in a strategic move deal value undisclosed but reported around \$935M to strengthen its global fraud-prevention and risk-scoring capabilities. Feature space's real-time machine-learning technology for analyzing transaction patterns and detecting financial-crime risks will enhance Visa's offerings to issuers and merchants. The acquisition supports Visa's push into deeper value-added services around security and trust.
Price: 1.1B  Acquisition of  March 2022	Advisors 	Synopsis SoFi acquired Technisys, a cloud-native digital banking platform, in a \$1.1B all-stock deal to accelerate its shift into a full-service financial technology ecosystem. Technisys provides a modern core banking system that enables faster product launches and scalable digital experiences. The acquisition strengthens SoFi's ability to build and customize financial products in-house, reduce third-party costs, and support its long-term strategy of becoming a leading end-to-end fintech platform.

IPO Activity

Snapshot

The fintech IPO market finally reopened after nearly two years of inactivity, supported by stabilizing macro conditions, improved public-market valuations, and strong underlying fintech fundamentals. Public fintech companies delivered exceptional performance through 2024–25. Specifically, neobanks, brokers, crypto platforms, and high-growth payments firms with many generating 40–100%+ returns over 90 days, signaling renewed investor confidence. The first wave of 2025 IPOs(Circle, Chime, eToro) highlighted that the market is willing to pay premium multiples for fintech's with clear profitability and durable business models. Pitchbook's Q2 2025 valuation data further confirms that high-growth cohorts saw upward multiple re-ratings as investors anticipated rate cuts and maintained strong risk appetite for efficient operators. Broader macro factors including inflation and reduced geopolitical risk creates a supportive environment for risk assets. Despite renewed enthusiasm, investors remain selective. Overall, investor appetite in H1'25 is strongest for scaled, profitable, infrastructure-centric fintech's, and with \$677B in global VC funding and strong public performance, conditions are in place for the largest and most disciplined fintech IPO cycle since 2021.

Snapshot



IPO Activity (cont')

USD 18.4 Billion

chime[®]

Chime Financial Inc

\$27/Share

June 2025

Underwriters

Morgan Stanley

J.P.Morgan

Goldman Sachs

Synopsis

Chime's [CHYM] IPO raised approximately \$864 million and was priced above the initial range (\$24-\$26), reflecting strong demand. A digital-banking neobank securing this capital raise after a quiet IPO environment signals renewed appetite for consumer fintech models that can scale profitably. For the fintech sector this listing reinforces that IPO windows are reopening for firms showing large addressable markets and clear growth. This IPO, helped restore belief that fintech public markets are viable again and valuations can reset upward when fundamentals align.

USD 5.6 Billion

eToro

eToro Group Ltd.

\$52/Share

May 2025

Underwriters

Goldman Sachs

citi

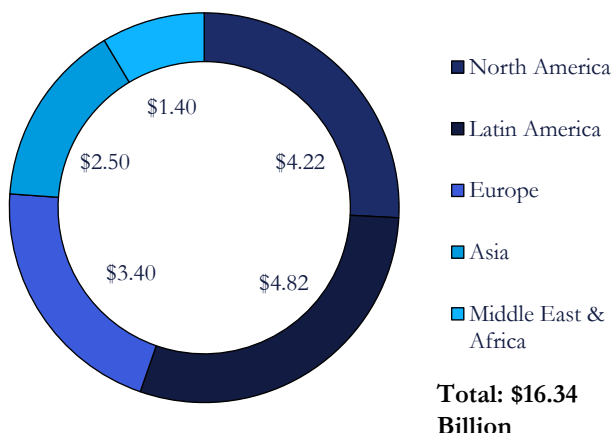
Jefferies

UBS

Synopsis

eToro's [ETOR] IPO raised about \$620M with shares climbing ~34% on the first day. The strong debut of a social-trading & retail-broker fintech company signaled that retail-facing fintech's particularly those combining brokerage, social features and crypto-adjacent services are favored. For the sector, eToro's performance highlights that investor appetite spans both infrastructure-oriented fintech (Circle) and consumer-oriented models (eToro), provided the growth is credible.

**Geographic IPO
Breakdown(\$Billions)**



2026 IPO Outlook

The 2026 IPO outlook for fintech seems increasingly constructive, supported by strengthened EBITDA and Revenue. With expected rate cuts, moderating inflation, and improving global liquidity; Pitchbook notes that many late-stage fintech's are now "IPO-ready" and simply waiting for volatility to subside. Several scaled fintech's are already positioned for 2026 listings, including Klarna, Toss, Mynt, Apex Fintech, Figure, PicPay, Ebury, and Groww, the most exciting watchlist since 2021. BCG highlights that over 150 fintechs founded before 2016 have raised \$500M+ and remain private, suggesting curbed supply that could drive a multi-wave IPO cycle once stabilized. If macro stability continues with improving investor sentiment, 2026 may have pre pandemic level IPO window.



BBR

BULL & BEAR RESEARCH

Initiating Coverage:

PayPal Holdings Inc. (NASDAQ: PYPL)



Get 3% cash back on
the category you choose
each month. (See app for details.)

Every payment.
Everywhere.
Every time.

The card is issued by The BancorpBank, N.A., licensed
in Texas by The BancorpBank, N.A. and is subject to
the cardholder's agreement. Mastercard is a registered
trademark of Mastercard International Inc. ©2019 PayPal

PayPal

PayPal

PayPal Holdings Inc. (PYPL)

PayPal is one of the leading digital payment platforms allowing users to both send and receive money globally while also storing money within their online application. Established in 1998, the company combines e-commerce and digital payments furthering the decentralization of traditional banking services. PayPal originally IPO'd in February 2002, but after eBay acquired them for \$1.5B just 6 months later, they remained private until their second IPO in July 2015. Having fostered a loyal consumer base through brands like Venmo, PayPal has cemented itself amongst the most preferred online mobile transaction services.

Differentiation and Strategy

- 434 million active accounts, as of early 2025, enabling extensive consumer data collection and scaling advantages.
- Strong consumer loyalty driven through PayPal and Venmo brands bolstering end user retention.
- Shift in focus towards branded transactions with higher margins rather than a low-margin brandless approach.

Financial Performance

- Generating revenue of roughly \$30B with net income totaling \$4B.
- Expanding operating margins to slightly below 20% with double digit EPS growth year-over-year.
- Upper management openly prioritizing profitability paying excess cash to shareholders through a \$15B share buyback and most recent \$0.14 per share dividend.
- Trading between \$56 and \$94 over the last 52 weeks with substantial room for growth having traded over \$300 per share in July 2021.

Recent Acquisitions

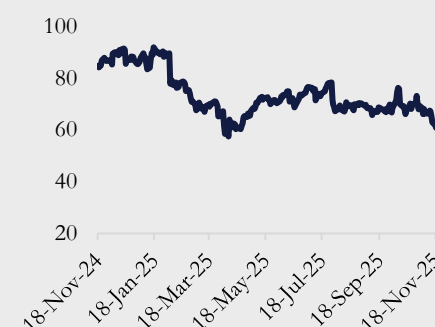
- Honey (\$4B ~ 2020): An online shopping and rewards company helping end-users find deals to save money. This synergistic acquisition was symbolic of PayPal's long-term mission to facilitate an entire online store separate from its core transaction services.
- Paidyz (\$2.7B ~ 2021): A Japanese “buy now, pay later” application acquired to establish geographical presence in Japanese markets.

Outlook

- Strong FCF's, a sizeable buyback, and dividend payouts signal broad confidence from upper management in the stability of earnings.
- As public sentiment and regulation shifts towards normalizing digital currency and transactions, 2021 highs leave substantial room for growth.
- Competition from adjacent transaction services like Apple Pay and Cash App further segment end users combating user retention efforts.

Stock Rating	Buy
BBR Price Target	\$87.00
Price (11/18/25)	\$60.70
Ticker	PYPL
Exchange	NASDAQ
Upside	38.40%

52 Week Range \$55.85 – \$60.70



Research Team

Raahil Gunaratne
Advay Vallabhapurapu
Eric Bullard
Sahil Shah
Shreyash Sinha

Multiples

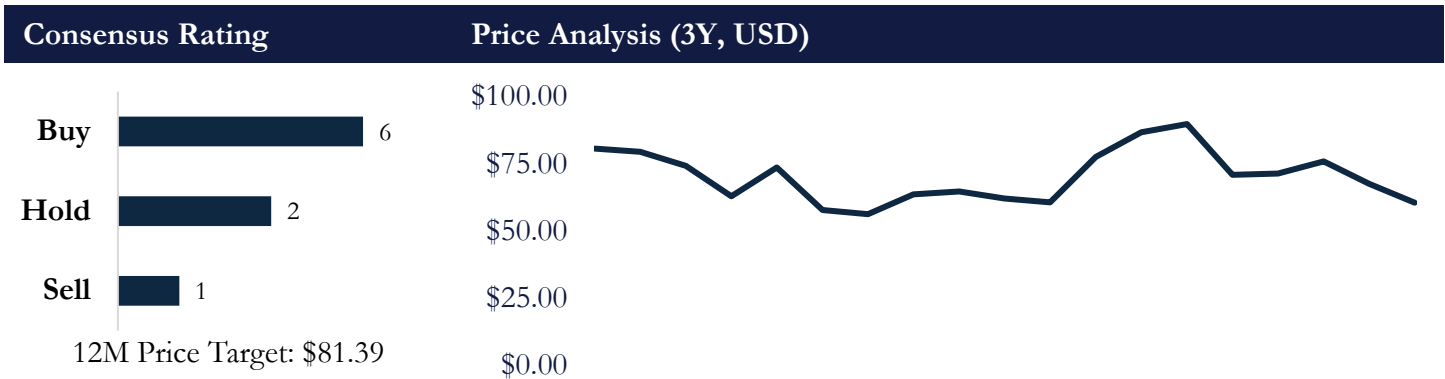
	PYPL	Peers
EV/Rev	2.08x	7.93x
P/E	14.76x	105.00x
EV/EBITDA	9.25x	25.85x

Stock Information

Market Cap (B)	\$65.85
Shares Outs. (mm)	935.65
Free Float (mm)	932.65
Dividend Yield (%)	0.92%

ALTERNATIVE VALUATIONS

PayPal Holdings Inc (PYPL)



Firm	Analyst	Date	Analyst Rating	Price Target	Comparative Analysis
BBR	Tech Coverage	11/24/25	Buy	\$87.00	
cg/Canaccord Genuity	Joseph Vafi	10/29/25	Buy	\$100.00	
UBS	Timothy Chiodo	10/29/25	Hold	\$80.00	
RBC	Daniel Perlin	10/28/25	Buy	\$91.00	
citi	Bryan Keane	10/22/25	Hold	\$78.00	
WELLS FARGO	Jason Kupferberg	10/22/25	Overweight	\$74.00	
ARGUS	Stephen Biggar	10/29/25	Buy	\$87.00	
KBW	Sanjay Sakhrani	10/29/25	Buy	\$90.00	
Goldman Sachs	Will Nance	10/13/35	Sell	\$70.00	

Select Commentary			
Royal Bank of Canada \$91 Price Target with a Buy rating on AXP, projections raised after PayPal's earnings release showing where quarterly revenue reached an \$8.29B and net profit raised to \$1.26B. Reflecting steady YoY growth and operational strength. - PayPal's diversified global user base continues to drive payment volume and engagement, supported by improving transaction margins and ongoing cost efficiencies. - Ongoing investment in payment innovation and digital experiences strengthens PayPal's position with both merchants and consumers.		Rating: Buy Price Target: \$91	Research Team: Daniel Perlin Jonathan Atkin Brad Erickson



Initiating Coverage:

American Express Co (NYSE: AXP)



American Express Co (AXP)

American Express (AMEX) is a global financial services company focused on integrated payments and physical payment cards. Founded in 1850, AMEX also provides payment processing via their proprietary network, travel services, and business solutions. AMEX generates revenue primarily through credit card balance interest charges, membership fees, and merchant discount fees. Competitors include Visa (NYSE:V) and Mastercard (NYSE:MA).

Differentiation and Strategy

- Closed-loop network:** AMEX issues cards via their banking subsidiaries which creates a closed-loop network. AMEX acts as both the issuer of the card and the merchant who is notified when a cardholder transacts. This creates an abundance of internal cardholder data that AMEX uses to differentiate customized offerings and increase cardholder retention.
- High-spend Customers:** An increased focus on luxurious perks including global lounge access and travel points has attracted affluent cardholders to chose AMEX over competitors. These high-spend clients have a higher on average spend-per-card, driving transactions fees and interest charges.

Financial Performance

- Revenue growth of 11% YoY in Q3 2025 totaling \$18.43B. Earnings per share (EPS) also inflated to \$4.14 with growth of 19% YoY.
- Current trailing price to earnings (P/E) ratio is ~24x, compared to a ~18x average over the last 10 years. Forward P/E ratio is also high at ~20x juxtaposed with a sector mean of ~11x.
- This premium is being driven by the recent double-digit revenue and EPS growth alongside investor confidence in the spending capacity of high-spend cardholders.

Recent Acquisitions

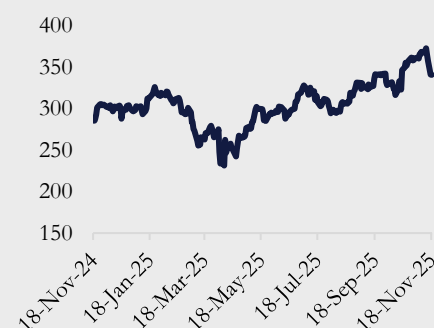
- Tock (\$400M – 2024):** Seemingly identical to their prior acquisition of Resy, Tock is an adjacent restaurant management software. AMEX aims to continue to expand their capabilities to provide cardholders with premium experiences at the finest dining establishments.
- Resy (\$200M ~ 2019):** Resy is an online reservation platform founded in 2014. AMEX acquired Resy to expand their footing in the dining and hospitality business while also expanding cardholder access to desired restaurants.

Outlook

- As Millennial and GenZ cardholders continue to increase their share of AMEX’s consumer demographic, AMEX expects a ~25% increase in transaction activity from younger members.
- Risks include regulatory pressure on credit card fees and rising customer acquisition costs with increasingly attractive perks from competitors.

Stock Rating	Hold
BBR Price Target	\$330.00
Price (11/18/25)	\$340.66
Ticker	AXP
Exchange	NYSE
Downside	-3.10%

52 Week Range \$285.42 – \$340.66



Research Team

Raahil Gunaratne
Advay Vallabhapurapu
Eric Bullard
Sahil Shah
Shreyash Sinha

Multiples

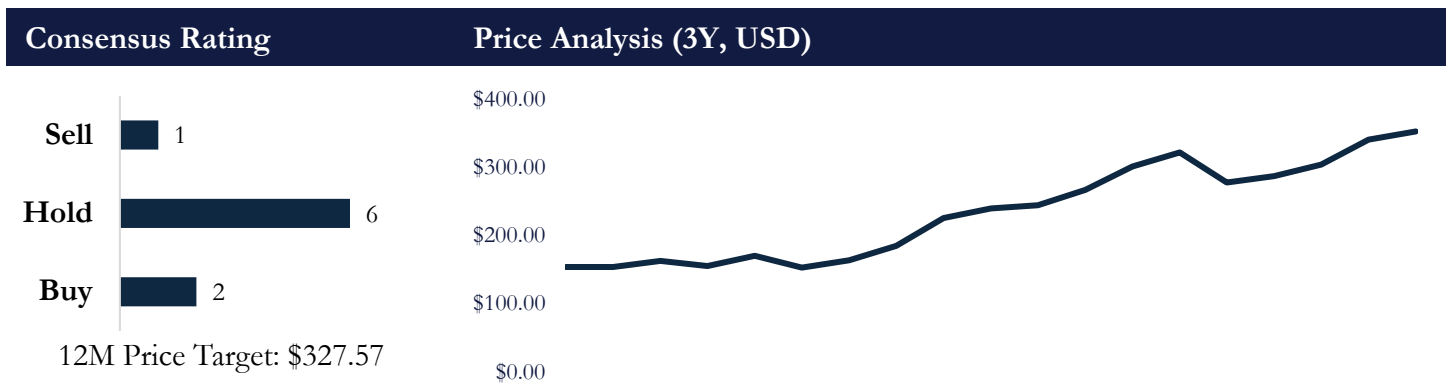
	AXP	Peers
EV/Rev	4.22x	7.93x
P/E	23.21x	105.00x
EV/EBITDA	15.82x	25.85x

Stock Information

Market Cap (B)	\$229.98
Shares Outs. (mm)	688.85
Free Float (mm)	535.75
Dividend Yield (%)	0.90%

ALTERNATIVE VALUATIONS

American Express Co (AXP)



Firm	Analyst	Date	Analyst Rating	Price Target	Comparative Analysis
BBR	Tech Coverage	11/24/25	Hold	\$330.00	
FREEDOM CAPITAL MARKETS	Mikhail Paramonov	10/24/25	Hold	\$325.00	
WELLS FARGO	Donald Fandetti	10/20/25	Overweight	\$400.00	
TRUIST	Brian Foran	10/20/25	Buy	\$395.00	
BARCLAYS	Terry Ma	10/20/25	Hold	\$355.00	
BTIG	Vincent Caintic	10/20/25	Sell	\$307.00	
UBS	Erika Najarian	10/7/25	Hold	\$340.00	
J.P.Morgan	Richard Shane	10/7/25	Hold	\$355.00	
EVERCORE	John Pancari	9/30/35	Hold	\$365.00	

Select Commentary			
Wells Fargo \$400 Price Target with an Overweight rating on AXP, raised from \$375 after strong Q3 earnings beat, revenues up 11% YoY and EPS up 19%, supporting a strong outlook on AMEX's revenue growth and profits - AXP's wealthy customer base is driving spending and great credit quality. Q3 spending grew 8-9%, combined with expenses and leverage, margins stay healthy (Q3 ROE 36%) - Investing in digital payments to enhance customer experience as well as Gen Z and Millennials add up to approximately 36% of AXP's spend	Rating: Overweight	Price Target: \$400	Research Team: Donald Fandetti Steven DeBartolo, CFA Micheal Kaye, CFA, CPA

Team Outlook

The Financial Technology industry preserves a positive long-term outlook largely due to financial service institutions continuing to transition a significant portion of their operations toward digitally based systems. The current demand in the market for payment solutions, financial integration, digital identity verification, and automated compliance management will continue to grow throughout consumer, institutional, and enterprise segments. Our team predicts that the Financial Technology adoption will gain even more momentum than it currently has, largely due to organizations needing more efficient transactions and stronger fraud protection services as well as significantly enhanced customer service capabilities. The FinTech sector continues to maintain its essential growth drivers that include mobile adoption, real-time payment systems, and data-based decision making even though there have been fundraising challenges and longer sales periods affecting some providers.

The industry will go through major development due to several market trends that are currently emerging as well as emerging in the future. Developments in Artificial Intelligence will improve underwriting precision, fraud detection capabilities, and customer service. Blockchain technology and tokenization systems will improve processing payments and money transfers across the world. The market in the future will see embedded finance like Apple Pay to continue to grow as financial services will be available through non-financial platforms that will essentially create an increase in new competition as well as growth in customer reach. Companies with great compliance-ready systems, flexible operations, as well as multiple revenue streams will attain better results than others. The FinTech ecosystem will go through the current technological process and endure market expansion as digital financial solutions deepen their penetration into markets across the globe.

Meet the Team



Raahil Gunaratne is a fourth year studying Finance and Corporate Innovation. Raahil draws on his most recent professional experience at Jefferies on their Fixed Income Sales Support team. He has also worked as a Structured Products Analyst at CAIS, an alternative investments firm based in New York City. Outside of BBR, Raahil serves as the Vice President of the Northeastern Xi-Beta chapter of the Kappa Sigma Fraternity.

Following graduation, Raahil will be returning to Jefferies to continue within his prior team as a 2026 Trade Operations Analyst.



Advay Vallabhapurapu is third-year studying Finance and Data Science. Advay brings experience from his role on the Alpha Team at State Street. He has prior experience in payments infrastructure from his time at Accelera Payments. Advay also serves as Senior Consultant at Northeastern Consulting Group and Philanthropy Coordinator with Dana-Farber Cancer Institute.

Advay is currently on co-op at State Street and is looking to further explore the intersection of finance and technology in future roles.



Eric Bullard is a third-year studying Finance and Mathematics. He has prior experience at Fidelity Investments as an Actuarial Consultant Co-Op and JPMorgan as an Investment Banking Risk Intern. He is also a part of the nationally ranked Northeastern Rugby team and a general member of the Northeastern Xi-Beta chapter of the Kappa Sigma Fraternity.

Eric will be returning to JPMorgan for Summer 2026 and is looking to pursue his next co-op in consulting, buy-side investing, or investment management.



Sahil Shah is a first-year studying Finance and Engineering. Sahil brings published research experience from his prior time researching the Velocity of Solar Flares at George Mason University. Sahil is also a Junior Associate at Huntington Angels Network, an Angel Investments club that connects Northeastern C-suite startups to investors.

Sahil is currently a Junior M&A Analyst at the Sellside Group and is looking to pursue his first co-op and summer internship in Equity Research or related buy-side analytical roles.



Shreyash Sinha is a third-year studying Computer Science and Finance. Shreyash brings experience from his prior time working as a Product Manager at a series E startup called Hydrow. He will be joining Jefferies in 2026 as a Fixed Income Derivatives trade support analyst working in New York. Shreyash is also an analyst at NUImpact, the largest Undergraduate ESG fund working on the Technology and Finance team.

Shreyash will be working for Jefferies in Spring of 2026 and is currently searching for a summer internship within Software Engineering or Product Management.